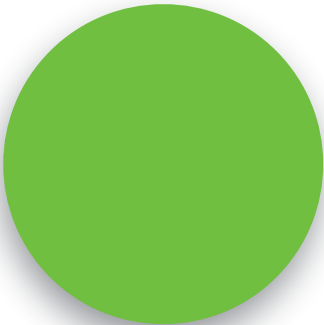
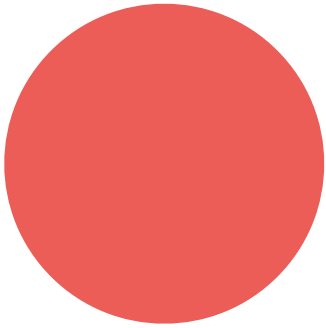




QUI COELVM CENIT MEDIVM QVE IMMORVE TRIBVNAL LVSTRAVIT QVE ANIMO CUNCTA POETA SVO DOCTVS ADEST DANTES SVA QVE FLORENTIA SAEPE
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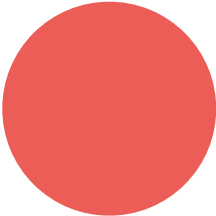












the existence of a perfectly good God.

traditional doctrine of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with

Let's try to layout Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

heaven and hell based on certain properties of these people. We will have

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to

Let's call them the relevant properties.

open for what those properties might be; just have a name for them,



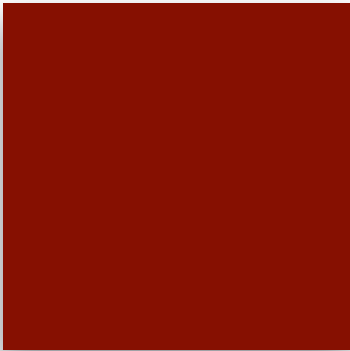








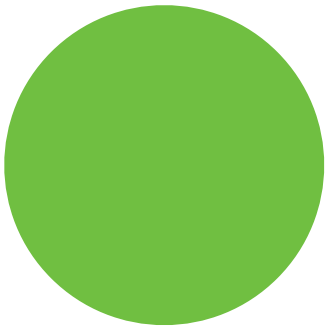


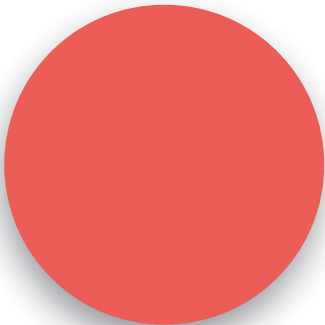




It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that

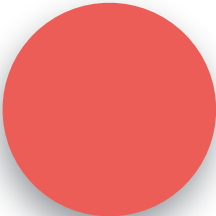
seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.





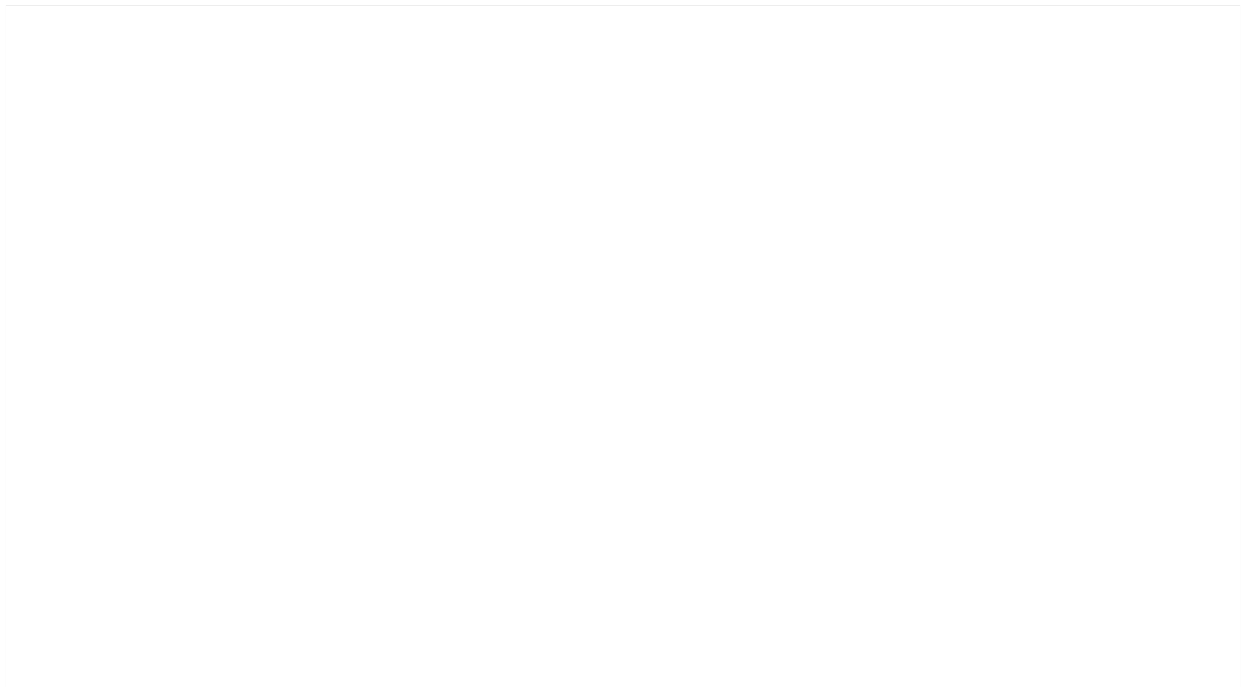






describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:

The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church



just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

eternis in die !!

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

all the nations, and he will separate them one from

another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

into external punishment, but the rights into

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by

many of the major monotheistic religions compatible with the existence of a

perfectly good Good?



goats, and the wild prairie sheep at his

they will go away into eternal punishment,

1038. The reservation of the dead, "of

Before him will be gathered all the nations,

and the wild sheep are then from another

as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

both the just and the unjust," will proceed

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

but the rights are all in it.

this glory, and all the angels with him.

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

got to heaven forever, and some others to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?

must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of

